1. Read the following text and identify how many paragraphs and sentences each of them has. Then, spot the topic and supporting sentences.

TEXT 2

Natural penicillins, penicillin G and penicillin V, are still used clinically. Because it has poor stability in acid, much of penicillin G is broken down when it passes through the stomach, so it must be given by intramuscular injection, which limits its usefulness but penicillin V is typically given orally as it is more resistant to digestive acids than penicillin G. Some of the semisynthetic penicillins are also more acid-stable so they may be given as oral medication.

All penicillins work in the same way: they destroy bacteria's cell walls. Also, other enzymes are activated to break down the protective wall of the microorganism. What's more, they are effective only against microorganisms that produce cell walls so they do not harm human cells (which fundamentally lack cell walls).

Penicillins are used in the treatment of throat infections, meningitis, syphilis, and various other infections.

ANSWER KEY

1. The text has 3 paragraphs

Paragraph 1

Natural penicillins, penicillin G and penicillin V, are still used clinically. Because it has poor stability in acid, much of penicillin G is broken down when it passes through the stomach, so it must be given by intramuscular injection, which limits its usefulness but penicillin V is typically given orally as it is more resistant to digestive acids than penicillin G. Some of the semisynthetic penicillins are also more acid-stable so they may be given as oral medication.

Topic sentence: Natural penicillins, penicillin G and penicillin V, are still used clinically.

Two Supporting Sentences: ***Because*** it has poor stability in acid, much of penicillin G is broken down when it passes through the stomach, ***so*** it must be given by intramuscular injection, which limits its usefulness ***but*** penicillin V is typically given orally as it is more resistant to digestive acids than penicillin G. Some of the semisynthetic penicillins are also more acid-stable so they may be given as oral medication.

Paragraph 2

All penicillins work in the same way: they destroy bacteria's cell walls. Also, other enzymes are activated to break down the protective wall of the microorganism. What's more, they are effective only against microorganisms that produce cell walls so they do not harm human cells (which fundamentally lack cell walls).

Topic Sentence: All penicillins work in the same way: they destroy bacteria's cell walls.

Two supporting sentences: ***Also***, other enzymes are activated to break down the protective wall of the microorganism. ***What's more***, they are effective only against microorganisms that produce cell walls so they do not harm human cells (which fundamentally lack cell walls).

Paragraph 3

One sentence: Penicillins are used in the treatment of throat infections, meningitis, syphilis, and various other infections.